AI SYNERGY HACKATHON 2026 · CASE 01 · ROUND 1

The Last-Mile AI Gap

Our proposal: AI Sathi, a way to make AI rules clear and learning visible for every student

Team [team name]

1 · WHAT WE UNDERSTOOD FROM THE CASE

31%
use generative AI every day. Another 32% rarely or never use it.

46%
have reliable laptop access, though 78% have a smartphone.

42%
find it easier to explain complex ideas in Hindi or mixed Hindi-English.

Rules change by department
Some faculty allow AI if disclosed, others ban it. Students are not sure where they stand.

Polished work is not proof of learning
Faculty say neat AI-assisted work does not always match what the student understands.

The case also reminds us that more AI use is not automatically better, so we are not trying to push usage up. Source: case evidence pack (simulated survey of 600 students).

2 · OUR PROBLEM STATEMENT

Students who use low-end phones, or who think best in Hindi or Hinglish, do not know what AI use is allowed and have no good way to show what they really understand. Rules differ across departments and assignments reward neat output, so these students fall further behind in confidence and in real learning.

We looked at six possible problems: access, AI literacy, confidence, assessment design, unclear policy and language. We picked unclear policy together with assessment design because the others largely follow from them, and because we can check them against what students actually submit.

3 · PROPOSED SOLUTION: AI SATHI

1. Clear AI rules
Every assignment carries a green, amber or red label for AI use, written in English and Hindi.

2. A study helper students can skip
A simple text chat in Hindi, Hinglish or English that works on a phone with limited data.

3. Explain your work
Students add a short note on how they reached their answer. Faculty mark it with a simple rubric.

4. A fairness check
College-level numbers compare results across device types and languages. Private chats are never read.

Ground rules: we never read private conversations, we judge ability only from submitted work, and we do not treat more AI use as better.

AI Sathi: how it runs and what comes next

4 · HOW IT WORKS

1	**Faculty set the rule**	Pick green, amber or red for the assignment and check the Hindi and English wording.
2	**Student reads it**	The rule shows on the phone before they start. Using the study helper is their choice.
3	**Student submits**	Work goes in with a short note explaining their thinking, in the language they prefer.
4	**Faculty mark understanding**	The tool suggests rubric points from the submission. The faculty member decides the marks.
5	**Administrators review**	Overall numbers show whether rules are clear and whether some groups are falling behind.

5 · WHO DOES WHAT: AI AND PEOPLE

AI helps with

- Translating rule labels into Hindi and Hinglish, which faculty check
- Answering study questions when a student asks
- Suggesting explain-your-work questions and rubric points
- Summarising overall trends for administrators

People decide

- Faculty choose the AI level for each task
- Faculty judge understanding and give every grade
- Students decide whether to use AI and say how they used it
- Administrators set policy and read the fairness numbers

6 · IS IT REALISTIC?

Area	Our plan	Still to confirm
Devices and data	A text-first web app in the phone browser. No install, light pages.	Real data limits on student plans
Language	Hindi, Hinglish and English in the app and the study helper.	Whether it improves learning
Faculty effort	One AI-use label and one rubric per task, from a ready template.	Whether faculty will adopt it
Scope	Start with one or two departments, then widen.	Which departments

7 · RISKS AND LIMITS WE KNOW ABOUT

Risk or limit	What we will do
Extra work for faculty	One label and one rubric per task, reused from a template.
Explain-your-work feels like being watched	Use only what students submit. No private chats are read.
Mistakes in Hindi or Hinglish text	Faculty approve the wording, and students try it before the pilot.
Students with fewer tools lose out	Keep AI optional, mark understanding not polish, and watch the gap by device type.
Our evidence is a simulated survey	We do not yet know why some students avoid AI, so we will ask them in a short poll.

8 · WHAT WE WILL BUILD IN ROUND 2

A working prototype

- Student screens on a phone: rule label, study helper, explain-your-work
- Faculty screen to set the AI level and mark with a rubric
- A fairness view using sample data

Quick checks with real people

- A short student poll on why some avoid AI
- Two or three conversations with faculty
- A test on a low-end phone with a slow connection

We will measure how clear the rules are, how much understanding shows in the explain-your-work tasks, and the gap between students with and without good devices. We will not measure how much AI students use.